

COLUMN | VINAY SHETTY

A digital world with endless plausibility



Vinay Shetty, ASUS Regional Director - Components Business, India and South Asia.

In November 2012, during our annual Sales and Marketing meeting in Taiwan, where all the top bosses of ASUS gather, company President Jonathan Tsang took stage to disclose, that the ASUS R&D team was working on manufacturing its very first robot. There was a stunned silence amongst most of us, with many looking at him in disbelief – reminiscent of the *Iron Man* movie when Tony Stark nonchalantly declared, “I am Iron Man”.

Cut to 2016, Pre Computex, ASUS launched Zenbo, its first AI powered home robot that could be programmed to provide assistance and entertainment to families using voice commands. Such is the pace of technology. Similarly, who knew even three years ago that remote working would become the future of work? This past year we have seen companies from every industry adopting work from home, and this change has opened yet another world of innovation opportunities.

Cloud Computing, 5G and AIoT

Another evolving trend is cloud computing – Be it remotely accessing

data, programs or information via the internet instead of an actual physical system. Cloud computing and high speed low latency network infrastructure will enable mass penetration of low cost network optimized devices and provide an experience like never before. For example, instead of an expensive end user device (phones / tablets etc.) we can deliver an uber experience to end users via cost efficient devices as all the compute will be on the cloud and the network infrastructure might already be 10G by then, which will be ultra low latency and high speed. With our cutting edge Graphic computing technology changing every year I can say with a degree of certainty that in the future the computational scalability to play a AAA game titles or even watching content in UHD 8k or 10k from your personal device is more within our grasp than ever.

AI is in our homes, our cars and in almost every piece of wearable technology that is being launched today. Coupled with IoT, our AIoT technology offers solutions to support customers and businesses in the development of fully integrated and efficient time-to-market applications and reduce their total cost of ownership. Robots and robotics will become a part of our lives and the digital world will be the centre of human life, be it travel, food, shopping, communicating. By 2041 we may even see our world, our cultures run by ASUS AI powered robots!

ASUS AIoT in Healthcare and Gaming

Healthcare is of pinnacle importance and we have witnessed why this industry should be the area of focus for every country. Digital healthcare in hospitals and clinics is becoming increasingly essential for providing seamless patient care and improved workflows to enhance the patient experience and improve satisfaction. In collaboration with Intel and VSee, our high-performance, battery operated

telemedicine carts will be one of the key drivers of healthcare. Powered by our popular Tinker Board line of single board computers (SBCs), it is a one stop healthcare solution for diagnosis, monitoring and support. Apart from being deployed at hospitals, the telemedicine cart can also be taken to a patient's home to enable doctors to legally make diagnoses and issue prescriptions, and neither doctor or patient needs to visit physically. Today we have made this technology mobile, can you imagine what we could transition to a few years from now?

Gaming as an industry is a thriving pool for innovation and studies from 'Global Market Insights' suggests it will grow 30% bigger by 2025. What was once considered to be recreational passing of time has leapfrogged into a lucrative career option. ASUS Tinkerboard S supports next-generation graphics and GPU computing APIs. A custom gaming machine is just one of an almost infinite variety of uses for Tinker Board S, a flexible SBC that provides great durability and stability to ensure excellent user experiences for DIY enthusiasts and makers everywhere. We have already opened dialogue with a few electronics companies to develop gaming machines on the Tinker Board S platform which will be used in gaming arcades, mall game stations and even recreational spaces in offices in the future.

Cybersecurity: The make or break

Remote working is the future, and it is dependent on how cybersecurity technology is developed for individuals, organisations, and governments. This is why we have robust commercial-grade home network security protection (ASUS AiProtection) on many of our ASUS router models. Cybersecurity needs to keep up or outpace the growth of AIoT and Cloud computing because, as convenient as digital has made our lives, it has made our privacy just as vulnerable. 